

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Komodo dragons were long thought to kill prey through bacteria-laden bites that caused fatal infections. However, in 2009 researcher Bryan Fry and colleagues discovered that Komodo dragons possess venom glands in their lower jaws, a finding that _____ the bacterial-infection hypothesis by providing an alternative explanation for the rapid decline of bitten prey.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: undermined

B: validated

C: refined

D: complicated

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'Alternative explanation' means the old one is weakened, not improved.

'Refined' is tempting (sounds like updating) but refining means improving an existing idea. 'Complicated' is too neutral. TRICK: 'Alternative explanation' = old one weakened = undermined.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Certain species of fireflies synchronize their flashing patterns so precisely that entire swarms blink in unison. Biologist Marta Selenko has argued that this coordinated behavior is not merely decorative but _____ a clear purpose: helping individual fireflies locate mates more efficiently against the visual noise of a dark forest.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: reflects

B: conceals

C: disputes

D: serves

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Not merely X but ____ Y' needs a positive verb. 'Reflects' is tempting but means 'shows,' not 'fulfills.' 'Conceals' is the opposite. TRICK: 'Serves a purpose' is the standard collocation -- the behavior fulfills, not just mirrors, the purpose.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Ocean temperatures in the Arctic have risen more rapidly than in other regions, causing sea ice to retreat at alarming rates. Climatologist Priya Deshpande notes that this accelerated warming has had a measurable _____ on polar bear hunting ranges, forcing the animals to travel greater distances to reach stable ice platforms.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: strain

B: impact

C: relief

D: precedent

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Measurable ____ on' needs a word meaning effect. 'Strain' is tempting but usually takes 'on a person,' not 'on ranges.' 'Precedent' sounds academic but means a prior example. TRICK: 'Measurable impact on' is standard academic phrasing for a cause-and-effect result.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Economist Layla Osman has observed that microfinance programs in rural areas often produce results that _____ the expectations of their designers. While program architects typically predict steady, incremental growth in borrowers' incomes, many participants instead experience erratic fluctuations driven by seasonal agricultural cycles.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: confirm

B: echo

C: defy

D: acknowledge

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'While' sets up contrast: predicted steady growth vs. actual erratic fluctuations. Results go AGAINST expectations. 'Confirm' and 'echo' both mean agree with -- reversal traps. TRICK: 'While' + opposite outcomes = the blank must mean 'go against.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In her analysis of urban transportation networks, sociologist Carmen Iglesias found that cities with extensive subway systems tend to have lower rates of traffic congestion than cities that rely primarily on buses. Her findings _____ the widely held view that underground rail reduces surface-level vehicle crowding.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: support

B: complicate

C: exaggerate

D: reject

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Findings align with the widely held view (subways = less congestion).

'Complicate' is tempting because findings could add nuance, but the data directly matches the view. TRICK: When evidence aligns cleanly with a claim, the word is 'support,' not 'complicate.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from a 1903 short story by Amara Okonkwo. The narrator describes a visit to her grandmother's garden.

The rows of tomato plants stood in perfect formation, each stalk tied to its post with careful precision. My grandmother surveyed her work with quiet satisfaction, adjusting a single wayward vine before stepping back to take in the full picture. She ran her garden the way she ran everything else -- with an iron will and a gentle hand.

As used in the text, what does the word "ran" most nearly mean?

A: Rushed through

B: Operated on

C: Inspected

D: Managed

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Ran everything else -- with an iron will' = oversaw with authority.

'Inspected' is tempting because she does survey the garden, but inspection is a single act, not ongoing management. TRICK: The literal/physical meaning of 'ran' (movement) is the trap; context = oversight and control.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Tomas Herrera's 1948 novel *The Copper Bell*. The narrator describes a bustling town square.

The marketplace hummed with the sharp cries of vendors and the shuffle of hurrying feet. A woman balanced a tower of clay pots on her head, weaving between stalls with practiced ease. The air was thick with the scent of roasting corn and fresh cilantro. For all its chaos, the square had a rhythm that any regular visitor could feel.

As used in the text, what does the word "thick" most nearly mean?

- A: Heavy
- B: Dense
- C: Opaque
- D: Humid

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Air thick with the scent' = air saturated with smells. 'Heavy' is close but is used for weight or burden, not concentration. 'Humid' tempts because it describes air quality but refers to moisture, not scent. TRICK: 'Dense with' = filled to a high concentration.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The construction of the transcontinental railroad in the 1860s dramatically _____ travel times across the United States. A journey from New York to San Francisco that had previously taken months by wagon or ship could now be completed in less than a week by train.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: extended

B: standardized

C: reduced

D: documented

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Months to less than a week = times went down. 'Extended' is the reversal. 'Standardized' is tempting because railroads did create uniform schedules, but the passage is about the decrease. TRICK: If the passage gives a before-after showing decrease, the word is 'reduced.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: During the Renaissance, the city-state of Florence became a center for artistic innovation. Wealthy families such as the Visconti and the Salviati _____ artists by commissioning paintings, sculptures, and architectural projects, ensuring that talented creators had the financial resources to pursue their work.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: patronized

B: supervised

C: penalized

D: imitated

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Families provided financial resources by commissioning works = acted as patrons. 'Supervised' is tempting because patrons do oversee, but the passage stresses FUNDING, not management. TRICK: In academic contexts, 'patronized' means financially supported as a patron, not 'talked down to.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The fruit of the baobab tree, sometimes called "monkey bread," contains high concentrations of vitamin C and antioxidants. Nutritionist Kenji Watanabe argues that baobab fruit could help _____ vitamin deficiencies in communities where access to fresh produce is limited, since the fruit can be dried and stored for long periods without losing its nutritional value.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: intensify

B: prevent

C: diagnose

D: address

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Help ___ deficiencies' = deal with existing problems. 'Prevent' is tempting but means stopping before it happens; communities already have deficiencies. 'Diagnose' is health-related but wrong action. TRICK: 'Address' means tackle an existing problem; 'prevent' means stop a future one.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Psychologist Rina Gupta found that students who studied in short, focused intervals performed better on memory tests than students who studied for extended, uninterrupted periods. Her results _____ the common belief that longer study sessions are always more productive.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: illustrate

B: contradict

C: reinforce

D: adopt

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Short intervals beat long sessions, but common belief says longer = better. Results oppose the belief. 'Illustrate' is the top trap: results DO show something, but they show the OPPOSITE of the belief. 'Reinforce' is another reversal. TRICK: If results oppose a belief, 'contradict' -- not 'illustrate,' which means demonstrate/confirm.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Nadia Petrov's 1955 novel Winter Crossing. The narrator describes a conversation with her father.

He delivered the news without ceremony, as though he were reading a list of groceries rather than announcing the family's departure from the only home we had ever known. His voice carried no weight of sadness, no tremor of regret. I searched his face for some crack in the composure, but he had sealed himself shut.

As used in the text, what does the word "weight" most nearly mean?

- A: Gravity
- B: Measurement
- C: Burden
- D: Significance

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Weight of sadness' is metaphorical -- the emotional load. 'Gravity' is tempting because it also means seriousness, but 'burden' captures the idea of carrying an emotional load. 'Significance' could fit 'weight of an argument' but not 'weight of sadness.' TRICK: Check what follows 'of' -- sadness is something carried, making 'burden' the best fit.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Coral reefs support roughly 25 percent of all known marine species despite occupying less than one percent of the ocean floor. Marine biologist Hana Yoshida describes reefs as _____ ecosystems, noting that even minor disturbances -- such as slight increases in water temperature -- can trigger widespread bleaching events that devastate entire reef communities.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: resilient
- B: dynamic
- C: interconnected
- D: fragile

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Even minor disturbances' cause 'widespread' damage = easily harmed.

'Resilient' is the reversal. 'Dynamic' sounds scientific but means actively changing, not easily damaged. 'Interconnected' is true of reefs but doesn't capture vulnerability.

TRICK: Small cause producing big damage = fragile, not resilient.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Historian Dalton Ngozi argues that the spread of the printing press in fifteenth-century Europe did not immediately make books _____ to the general public. Although printing reduced production costs, books remained expensive relative to average wages for several decades after the technology's introduction.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: affordable
- B: accessible
- C: portable
- D: controversial

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'Remained expensive relative to wages' = still too costly to buy. 'Accessible' is the strongest distractor -- it sounds close, but the passage specifies the barrier is COST, not availability or physical access. TRICK: Read the sentence after the blank -- 'remained expensive' pins the meaning to affordability.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Ancient Egyptian physicians documented treatments for various ailments on papyrus scrolls, creating some of the earliest known medical texts. These records reveal that Egyptian healers possessed a surprisingly _____ understanding of human anatomy, including knowledge of the heart's role in circulating blood through the body.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: rudimentary
- B: sophisticated
- C: theoretical
- D: controversial

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Surprisingly' + specific knowledge of blood circulation = advanced. 'Rudimentary' is the reversal (basic, not advanced). 'Theoretical' is tempting because ancient knowledge might seem theory-based, but the passage presents practical knowledge of anatomy. TRICK: 'Surprisingly ____' = the word must be unexpected; basic knowledge would not be surprising.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Celeste Moreau's 1932 novel *The Orchard Path*. The narrator recalls a childhood summer.

Every evening, Aunt Margaux would plant herself in the wicker chair on the porch and hold court, dispensing opinions on the neighbors' gardens, the weather, and the state of the nation with equal authority. No one dared interrupt her; she commanded the conversation the way a general commands a regiment.

As used in the text, what does the word "court" most nearly mean?

- A: A formal debate
- B: A legal tribunal
- C: An audience
- D: A performance

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Hold court' = preside over listeners. 'Performance' is tempting because she IS performing in a sense, but 'court' specifically means the gathered listeners, not the act. 'Formal debate' is tempting because she gives opinions, but nobody argues back.

TRICK: 'Hold court' is an idiom meaning command an audience -- focus on the listeners, not the speaker's style.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Researchers studying sleep patterns in adolescents have found that early school start times often _____ students' natural circadian rhythms, which tend to shift toward later bedtimes and wake times during puberty. As a result, many teenagers arrive at school already fatigued.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: align with

B: respond to

C: result from

D: conflict with

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Early start times vs. later rhythms = mismatch. 'Align with' is the reversal. 'Result from' reverses the causation (start times don't come from rhythms). TRICK: Early vs. late = opposition = 'conflict with.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Julian Hargrove's 1961 novel *The Watchmaker's Daughter*. The narrator describes the family workshop.

My father's hands moved with a precision that I could only marvel at. Each tiny gear, each spring no bigger than an eyelash, found its place under his steady fingers. He never rushed. The work demanded patience, and he gave it freely, treating each watch as though it were the only one in the world.

As used in the text, what does the word "demanded" most nearly mean?

- A: Required
- B: Commanded
- C: Challenged
- D: Warranted

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'The work demanded patience' = the work called for/needed patience.

'Commanded' sounds authoritative but implies a person giving orders. 'Challenged' is tempting but means tested or contested, not needed. TRICK: When work is the subject, 'demanded' means required, not ordered.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Archaeologist Fatima al-Rashid discovered that ancient Mesopotamian traders used standardized clay tokens to record commercial transactions. These tokens _____ an early form of bookkeeping, predating written language by thousands of years.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: preceded

B: represented

C: replaced

D: inspired

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Tokens 'were' an early form of bookkeeping = they constituted/served as it. 'Preceded' is tempting because they came before written language, but the blank is about what the tokens WERE, not what came before what. 'Inspired' is tempting but means they triggered later bookkeeping, not that they themselves WERE bookkeeping. TRICK:

'Represented' means served as or constituted.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The population of monarch butterflies that migrates annually from Canada to central Mexico has declined sharply over the past two decades. Conservationist Elara Voss attributes this decline primarily to the _____ of milkweed, the only plant on which monarchs lay their eggs, from farmlands where herbicide use has become widespread.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: distribution

B: cultivation

C: disappearance

D: regulation

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Herbicide removes milkweed from farmlands. 'Cultivation' is the reversal (growing, not removing). 'Distribution' is tempting because it relates to where milkweed is found, but the passage says herbicides destroy it, not redistribute it. TRICK: Herbicide + plant = the plant is eliminated, not moved.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In her study of early childhood language acquisition, linguist Saoirse Byrne found that bilingual toddlers often _____ between languages within a single sentence, a phenomenon known as code-switching. Rather than indicating confusion, this behavior demonstrates a sophisticated awareness of grammatical rules in both languages.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: struggle

B: transition

C: hesitate

D: alternate

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Code-switching = going back and forth between languages. 'Transition' is the strongest distractor -- it sounds like switching, but implies a complete shift from one to another, not repeated back-and-forth. 'Struggle' and 'hesitate' both imply difficulty, which the passage rejects ('sophisticated'). TRICK: 'Alternate' = switch repeatedly; 'transition' = shift once.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Rosa Medina's 1978 short story collection *Salt and Stone*. The narrator describes her grandfather's woodworking shop.

The shop was a kingdom of sawdust and varnish, every surface covered in curls of pale wood. Grandfather kept his tools in strict order -- chisels ranked by size along the wall, saws hanging from iron hooks, sandpaper stacked in neat columns. He tolerated no disorder. Even a misplaced pencil could draw a sharp look from those dark, watchful eyes.

As used in the text, what does the word "draw" most nearly mean?

A: Provoke

B: Sketch

C: Attract

D: Illustrate

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'Draw a sharp look' = cause/elicit a look. 'Sketch' is the literal-meaning trap (drawing with a pencil). 'Attract' is tempting -- it almost works, but you 'attract attention,' not 'attract a look.' TRICK: When 'draw' has 'a reaction' as its object, it means provoke/elicit.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The ancient Romans constructed an extensive network of roads stretching across their empire, many of which remain partially intact today. Historian Marcus Chen notes that this infrastructure _____ not only military movement but also trade and cultural exchange between distant provinces.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: prohibited

B: regulated

C: facilitated

D: anticipated

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Roads enabled movement, trade, and exchange = made easier. 'Regulated' is the strongest distractor because infrastructure can regulate movement, but the passage stresses enabling, not controlling. 'Prohibited' is the reversal. TRICK: Roads are described as connecting distant provinces -- the function is enabling, not restricting.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Though many people associate deserts exclusively with extreme heat, nighttime temperatures in some desert regions can drop below freezing. This dramatic temperature _____ between day and night occurs because dry desert air lacks the moisture needed to retain heat after sunset.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: consistency

B: swing

C: gradient

D: plateau

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Extreme heat by day vs. freezing at night = wide shift. 'Gradient' is the strongest distractor -- it's a scientific term for change, but gradients describe change over distance or space, not the back-and-forth between extremes. 'Consistency' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Swing' describes movement between two extremes, not a gradual spatial change.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Geologist Ayesha Farooq has argued that conventional models of volcanic eruption prediction rely too heavily on seismic data alone. She contends that integrating satellite-based measurements of ground deformation would significantly _____ the accuracy of these models, since subtle surface changes often precede eruptions by weeks or months.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: approximate

B: replicate

C: diminish

D: bolster

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Adding satellite data would improve accuracy. 'Approximate' is tempting because it sounds like getting closer to accuracy, but it means estimate roughly, not strengthen. 'Diminish' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Bolster' means strengthen/reinforce; 'approximate' means give a rough estimate.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 26

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Musicologist Ravi Shankar Iyer has observed that the sitar, though often perceived in Western countries as a purely traditional instrument, has undergone considerable _____ over the past century. Modern sitars feature steel strings, moveable frets, and resonating chambers that differ markedly from those of their eighteenth-century predecessors.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: modification
- B: preservation
- C: standardization
- D: deterioration

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Steel strings, moveable frets, different chambers = changes. 'Preservation' is the reversal (keeping same). 'Standardization' is tempting because instruments can be standardized, but the passage lists diverse changes, not uniformity. 'Deterioration' is tempting with 'undergone' but the changes are improvements. TRICK: 'Perceived as traditional' contrasts with 'undergone considerable ____' -- changes, not preservation.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 27

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Political scientist Nkechi Adeyemi notes that voter turnout in municipal elections is typically far lower than in national contests. She attributes this _____ partly to a widespread misconception that local government decisions have little effect on residents' daily lives, when in fact municipal policies shape everything from zoning regulations to public school funding.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: incentive
- B: surplus
- C: disparity
- D: ambiguity

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Municipal turnout much lower than national = a gap. 'Ambiguity' is tempting because it sounds analytical, but the passage describes a clear gap, not confusion. 'Incentive' relates to voting but describes motivation, not the gap itself. TRICK: 'This ____' refers back to the lower-vs-higher turnout comparison = a measurable difference = disparity.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 28

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Kaede Nakamura's 1965 novel *The Paper Lantern*. The narrator recounts attending a ceremony.

The old priest spoke in a voice so low that the gathered mourners had to strain forward to catch his words. Each syllable fell like a pebble into still water, sending ripples of silence through the crowd. Even the children, usually restless at such events, were arrested by the gravity of the moment.

As used in the text, what does the word "arrested" most nearly mean?

- A: Subdued
- B: Halted
- C: Detained
- D: Startled

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Children usually restless were 'arrested by the gravity' = stopped in their tracks by the solemnity. 'Detained' is the literal/legal meaning trap. 'Subdued' is tempting -- it means quieted, but 'arrested' specifically means stopped/frozen, not merely calmed. 'Startled' implies surprise/fear, but the tone is solemn. TRICK: 'Arrested' + 'gravity of the moment' = held motionless by seriousness.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 29

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Although the axolotl, a salamander native to Mexico's Lake Xochimilco, is critically endangered in the wild, it _____ in laboratory settings worldwide. Scientists prize the species for its extraordinary ability to regenerate lost limbs, making it an invaluable model organism for regenerative medicine research.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: deteriorates

B: adapts

C: persists

D: thrives

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Although' sets up a contrast: endangered (negative) vs. blank (must be positive). 'Persists' is the strongest distractor -- it means survives, which contrasts with endangered, but 'thrives' is stronger and matches 'invaluable model organism.'

'Adapts' is tempting but describes HOW it adjusts, not HOW WELL it does. TRICK: 'Although' signals the strongest possible contrast -- 'thrives' is more positive than 'persists.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 30

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Linguist Yuki Tanaka has found that speakers of tone languages -- languages like Mandarin, in which pitch changes alter a word's meaning -- tend to have a heightened ability to _____ subtle differences in musical pitch. This finding suggests a link between linguistic experience and auditory perception.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: discern

B: generate

C: replicate

D: appreciate

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'Heightened ability to ____' subtle pitch differences = detect fine distinctions. 'Appreciate' is tempting because they could value differences, but the passage is about perceptual ABILITY, not enjoyment. 'Replicate' means reproduce, not detect. TRICK: 'Discern' means perceive fine distinctions -- the most precise word for detecting subtle differences.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 31

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Eloise Germaine's 1927 novella *The Linen Room*. The narrator describes her employer, Mrs. Whitfield.

Mrs. Whitfield was not unkind, but she practiced a rigid economy in all things, including affection. Praise from her was so rare that when it arrived, it carried the force of a proclamation. The household staff lived under a regime of efficiency and silence, and any lapse -- a wrinkled tablecloth, a smudged window -- was met with a look that could wither flowers.

As used in the text, what does the word "economy" most nearly mean?

- A: Efficiency
- B: Investment
- C: Restraint
- D: Balance

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Rigid economy in all things, including affection' = sparing with everything, even love. 'Efficiency' is the strongest distractor -- it sounds right because Mrs. Whitfield IS efficient, but 'economy' here means being sparing/limited, not productive. 'Balance' implies equilibrium, not restriction. TRICK: 'Economy' + 'rigid' + applied to affection = deliberate limitation, not productivity.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 32

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Architect Lucia Reyes argues that the trend toward glass-walled office buildings in tropical cities is fundamentally misguided. In hot climates, extensive glass facades dramatically increase cooling costs and energy consumption, _____ the very sustainability goals that many of these buildings' developers publicly champion.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: advancing
- B: undermining
- C: redefining
- D: measuring

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Higher energy costs work AGAINST sustainability goals. 'Advancing' is the reversal. 'Redefining' is tempting because the buildings change what sustainability means in practice, but the passage presents a direct contradiction, not a redefinition. TRICK: 'The very goals' + 'publicly champion' signals irony -- the buildings contradict their own stated values = undermining.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 33

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Despite their reputation as solitary predators, recent studies have revealed that some leopard populations display unexpectedly _____ behavior. In Kenya's Laikipia Plateau, wildlife biologist Amani Okafor documented instances of adult males sharing kills with unrelated females and tolerating the presence of neighboring males at water sources.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: social

B: aggressive

C: territorial

D: cooperative

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'Despite solitary predators' = the behavior contrasts with solitude. Sharing kills and tolerating others = communal behavior. 'Cooperative' is the strongest distractor -- it's close, but implies actively working together on a shared task, whereas tolerating presence and sharing are social (communal) rather than cooperative (goal-directed). TRICK: 'Despite solitary' = the word must be the opposite of solitary. 'Social' is the direct antonym.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 34

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Economist Miriam Osei-Bonsu contends that policies designed to _____ urban sprawl -- such as higher-density zoning requirements and investments in public transit -- often face resistance from suburban homeowners who fear that increased density will reduce their property values.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: define

B: promote

C: monitor

D: curtail

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Policies fight sprawl: higher density and transit = limiting outward expansion. 'Promote' is the reversal. 'Monitor' is tempting because policies could track sprawl, but the examples (zoning, transit) are active interventions, not observation.

TRICK: The dashed list gives the answer -- higher density and transit are tools to LIMIT sprawl.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 35

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Dmitri Volkov's 1951 novel *The Amber Coast*. The narrator describes a chess match.

Krupov studied the board with the patience of a man who had nowhere else to be. He lifted his knight, held it suspended over the board for a long moment, then returned it to its original square. The gesture was deliberate -- a feint, designed to rattle his opponent. Across the table, Petrov's jaw tightened almost imperceptibly.

As used in the text, what does the word "deliberate" most nearly mean?

A: Slow

B: Cautious

C: Intentional

D: Obvious

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'A feint, designed to rattle' = done on purpose. 'Slow' is the common-meaning trap -- deliberate can mean unhurried, but 'designed to' confirms PURPOSE, not pace.

'Cautious' is tempting because chess involves careful thought, but the gesture was an aggressive tactic, not a cautious one. TRICK: Read what follows the dash -- 'designed to rattle' tells you the gesture was purposeful.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 36

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Historian Claudette Benoit has argued that the popular narrative of the French Revolution as a sudden eruption of popular rage oversimplifies a far more _____ process. Years of crop failures, fiscal mismanagement, and philosophical debate had gradually eroded confidence in the monarchy long before the storming of the Bastille.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: volatile

B: gradual

C: secretive

D: predictable

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Sudden eruption' is the oversimplification; reality = 'years' of factors 'gradually eroded.' 'Volatile' is tempting because revolutions ARE volatile, but the passage contrasts 'sudden' with a slow process. 'Predictable' is tempting because gradual could seem foreseeable, but the passage is about speed, not foreseeability. TRICK: The passage literally uses 'gradually' -- the blank must mean the opposite of 'sudden.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 37

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Neuroscientist Liora Stern's research has revealed that chronic sleep deprivation does not merely cause fatigue but also impairs the brain's ability to consolidate memories. Her findings suggest that the effects of prolonged sleeplessness are _____ previously understood: rather than a simple lack of energy, the consequences include measurable cognitive decline.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: more extensive than
- B: less significant than
- C: consistent with what was
- D: unrelated to what was

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'Not merely fatigue but also memory impairment' = wider than thought.

'Consistent with' is tempting because the findings DO relate to prior knowledge, but they go BEYOND it. 'Less significant' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Not merely X but also Y' = more than previously understood = 'more extensive than.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 38

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Urban planner Takeshi Morimoto found that neighborhoods with abundant street trees experience significantly lower summer temperatures than those without tree cover. The shade and evapotranspiration provided by mature trees can _____ the urban heat island effect, which occurs when concrete and asphalt absorb and radiate solar energy.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: intensify
- B: illustrate
- C: replicate
- D: mitigate

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trees lower temperatures, counteracting the heat island effect. 'Intensify' is the reversal. 'Illustrate' is tempting because trees DO demonstrate the effect by showing the contrast, but the passage is about trees REDUCING the effect, not showing it. TRICK: 'Mitigate' is the standard word for reducing a negative effect -- lower temperatures = reducing heat.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 39

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Anya Krishnamurthy's 2004 novel *The Spice Merchant's Ledger*. The narrator describes a marketplace negotiation.

My uncle conducted his haggling with a theatrical flair that delighted onlookers and infuriated his rivals. He would gasp at a price as though personally wounded, clutch his chest, declare himself ruined -- then, just as the seller began to soften, he would press his advantage with ruthless precision. His performance was as polished as any actor's.

As used in the text, what does the word "press" most nearly mean?

- A: Assert
- B: Flatten
- C: Push
- D: Conceal

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Press his advantage' = capitalize/push forward aggressively. 'Assert' is the strongest distractor -- asserting an advantage is plausible, but 'press' implies active forward PRESSURE, not just stating a position. 'Flatten' is the literal/physical meaning trap. TRICK: 'Press' + 'with ruthless precision' = aggressive forward motion, not a declaration.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 40

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Sociologist Anika Hoffman argues that the digital divide -- the gap between those who have access to modern information technology and those who do not -- cannot be addressed solely through the distribution of devices. Without adequate training and technical support, she notes, donated laptops and tablets often go unused, leaving the underlying _____ in digital literacy unresolved.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: surplus

B: dearth

C: disparity

D: innovation

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Devices go unused, people lack training = shortage of digital literacy. 'Surplus' is the reversal. 'Disparity' is the strongest distractor -- there IS a gap (the digital divide), but the blank specifically describes the SHORTAGE of literacy, not the gap between groups. TRICK: 'Underlying ____ in digital literacy' = what's missing = a dearth (scarcity).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 41

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Despite being one of the most prolific composers of the Baroque era, Georg Philipp Telemann has long been overshadowed by his contemporary Johann Sebastian Bach. Music historian Elara Kowalski argues that this _____ is unwarranted, pointing out that Telemann's works were more widely performed during his lifetime and that his innovations in orchestral form influenced generations of later composers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: rivalry

B: controversy

C: celebrity

D: neglect

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Overshadowed' = overlooked. 'Rivalry' is tempting because Telemann and Bach were contemporaries, but the passage describes being ignored, not competing. 'Controversy' is tempting because arguing something is 'unwarranted' sounds like a debate, but the 'this' refers to being overshadowed. TRICK: 'This ____' points back to the previous sentence -- 'overshadowed' = neglected.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 42

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Ecologist Tara Mackenzie has documented the phenomenon of "ecological traps," in which animals are attracted to environments that appear suitable but are actually harmful. For instance, some species of sea turtles mistake the glow of coastal development for moonlight reflecting off the ocean, a confusion that _____ hatchlings away from the sea and toward dangerous roads and buildings.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: lures

B: guides

C: shields

D: diverts

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Hatchlings are attracted toward danger by deceptive light. 'Guides' is tempting because it means directs, but it lacks the sense of deception. 'Diverts' is the strongest distractor -- it means redirects, which fits, but 'lures' better captures the deceptive attraction. TRICK: 'Ecological traps' = deception. 'Lures' implies attraction toward harm; 'diverts' merely redirects.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 43

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Samuel Ogunjimu's 1989 novel *The Indigo Hour*. The narrator describes his father's reaction to unexpected news.

My father received the letter in silence, his expression betraying nothing. He folded it twice with mechanical precision and placed it inside his coat pocket. Only when he turned toward the window did I notice the almost imperceptible tremor in his hand -- a small fissure in the composure he wore like armor.

As used in the text, what does the word "wore" most nearly mean?

A: Endured

B: Displayed

C: Concealed

D: Eroded

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Composure he wore like armor' = composure he put on as a protective covering. 'Endured' is tempting because 'wore' can mean suffered through wear and tear, but 'like armor' confirms the clothing/display meaning. 'Concealed' is the opposite -- armor is visible, not hidden. TRICK: 'Like armor' = protective covering on the outside = displayed.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 44

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Paleontologist Haruto Ito challenges the popular image of Tyrannosaurus rex as an exclusively active predator. Ito's analysis of bone isotopes suggests that T. rex may have been partly _____, supplementing its diet by scavenging the carcasses of animals killed by other predators or natural causes, much as modern hyenas do.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: herbivorous

B: sedentary

C: opportunistic

D: nocturnal

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Supplementing by scavenging = taking available food as opportunity arises. 'Herbivorous' tempts students who read 'not exclusively predatory' as 'plant-eating,' but the alternative is scavenging, not herbivory. 'Sedentary' is tempting because scavenging is less active than hunting, but scavengers still travel widely. TRICK: Scavenging = taking advantage of available food = opportunistic.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 45

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Cognitive psychologist Mei-Ling Zhou found that people who were asked to evaluate the credibility of news articles while multitasking were significantly more likely to accept false claims as true than people who evaluated the same articles without distractions. Her results underscore the idea that critical thinking requires _____ attention.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: divided

B: selective

C: intermittent

D: sustained

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Multitasking (split attention) leads to failure; undivided attention leads to success. 'Divided' is the trap -- it describes what FAILS, not what's needed. 'Selective' is tempting because it sounds focused, but it means choosing what to attend to, not maintaining attention over time. TRICK: The passage contrasts distraction (failure) with focus (success) -- the needed quality is continuous, unbroken attention = sustained.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 46

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The ancient Incan practice of using quipus -- knotted strings of varying colors and lengths -- to record information has long puzzled researchers. While most scholars agree that quipus served as numerical record-keeping devices, anthropologist Daniela Fuentes contends that their function was far more _____, arguing that certain knot patterns may have encoded narratives and historical accounts.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: expansive
- B: conventional
- C: precise
- D: limited

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Numbers only vs. numbers + narratives = broader scope. 'Limited' is the reversal. 'Conventional' is tempting because Fuentes challenges the standard view, but the blank describes the FUNCTION being broader, not the view being unconventional. 'Precise' is tempting but scope, not accuracy, is the issue. TRICK: 'Far more ____' than numerical only = wider in scope = expansive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 47

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Irene Castellanos's 1971 novel *Saltwater*. The narrator recalls a visit to her aunt's coastal home.

Aunt Viviana was a woman of formidable opinions. She dismissed most modern conveniences as frivolous and cooked every meal over a wood fire, regarding the gas stove in her kitchen as an unwelcome intruder. Yet for all her stubbornness, she harbored a single, surprising concession to modernity: a small transistor radio that she kept on the windowsill, tuned perpetually to a station playing boleros.

As used in the text, what does the word "harbored" most nearly mean?

- A: Sheltered
- B: Maintained
- C: Concealed
- D: Resented

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Harbored a concession' = kept one exception. 'Sheltered' is the literal/maritime meaning trap. 'Concealed' is tempting because 'harbor' can mean hide, but the radio is openly on the windowsill, not hidden. 'Resented' might fit her attitude toward modernity, but she chose to keep the radio. TRICK: Check context -- the radio is visible, not hidden, so 'concealed' is wrong. 'Maintained' = kept/held.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 48

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Biochemist Oladele Adewumi has shown that certain bacteria in deep-sea hydrothermal vents synthesize organic compounds without sunlight, using chemical energy from mineral-rich water instead. This process, known as chemosynthesis, challenges the long-standing assumption that all food chains ultimately _____ photosynthesis.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: rival

B: produce

C: depend on

D: precede

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Assumption: all food chains need photosynthesis as their energy base. Chemosynthesis disproves this. 'Precede' is tempting because it could mean food chains come before photosynthesis, but the assumption is about reliance, not timing. 'Rival' implies competition, not dependence. TRICK: The assumption is that photosynthesis is the necessary foundation = all food chains depend on it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 49

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Art historian Yael Ben-Ari notes that Impressionist painters were initially met with sharp criticism from the established art world, which dismissed their loose brushwork and unfinished appearance as amateurish. Today, however, Impressionism is among the most _____ movements in Western art, with works by its practitioners commanding record prices at auction.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: obscure

B: polarizing

C: austere

D: revered

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Past: criticism. Present: record prices. 'Polarizing' is the strongest distractor -- Impressionism is well known and could be debated, but 'record prices at auction' indicates ADMIRATION, not division. 'Obscure' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Today, however' signals a reversal from past criticism -- the present must be strongly positive = revered.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 50

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Environmental scientist Kofi Mensah has observed that reforestation efforts in degraded tropical landscapes sometimes fail because planners select tree species for their rapid growth rate rather than for their ecological compatibility with the existing soil and climate conditions. Mensah advocates a more _____ approach, one that considers soil chemistry, water availability, and the needs of local wildlife before any trees are planted.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: methodical

B: aggressive

C: conventional

D: perfunctory

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Failed: quick picks. Recommended: consider soil, water, wildlife = systematic. 'Perfunctory' is the reversal (describes the failing approach). 'Conventional' is tempting but the passage contrasts careless vs. careful, not old vs. new. TRICK: A list of factors to consider (soil, water, wildlife) signals a thorough, step-by-step approach = methodical.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 51

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Literary critic Aduaeze Nwosu has argued that the novels of the Harlem Renaissance, far from being merely artistic achievements, served as powerful vehicles for social commentary. Writers like Nella Larsen and Claude McKay used fiction to _____ the racial inequities of their era, embedding pointed critiques of segregation within compelling narratives that reached broad audiences.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: navigate

B: conceal

C: expose

D: chronicle

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Pointed critiques' = revealing inequities, not just recording them.

'Chronicle' is the strongest distractor -- it means record, which is close, but the passage stresses CRITIQUE, not neutral documentation. 'Navigate' is tempting but means deal with, not reveal. TRICK: 'Pointed critiques' signals the intent to reveal and challenge, not simply to record.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 52

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Neuroscientist Clara Johansson has found that bilingual individuals tend to show greater cognitive flexibility than monolingual individuals on tasks requiring rapid switching between different sets of rules. However, Johansson cautions against overstating this advantage, noting that the _____ between bilingual and monolingual performance is modest and may be influenced by factors other than language experience, such as socioeconomic background.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: consensus
- B: gap
- C: correlation
- D: format

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Bilingual vs. monolingual performance difference = a measurable gap.

'Correlation' is the strongest distractor -- there IS a correlation between bilingualism and flexibility, but the blank refers to the SIZE of the difference, not the relationship itself. TRICK: 'Modest' describes a size, which modifies a difference/gap, not a relationship/correlation.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 53

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Helena Okoro's 1984 short story "The Market Woman." The narrator observes a vendor at her stall.

Mama Bisi arranged her tomatoes with the gravity of a jeweler setting stones. Each fruit was examined, turned, and placed just so -- the reddest specimens at the front, the bruised ones discreetly tucked behind. Her display was a carefully constructed argument for quality, and she prosecuted it with unwavering conviction.

As used in the text, what does the word "prosecuted" most nearly mean?

- A: Judged
- B: Investigated
- C: Contested
- D: Pursued

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Prosecuted an argument with conviction' = carried it forward with determination. 'Contested' is tempting because it sounds like arguing, but contesting means opposing, and she's advancing her OWN argument, not opposing someone else's. 'Investigated' is a different legal action. TRICK: 'Prosecute' in figurative use = pursue vigorously, not convict or contest.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 54

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Physicist Andrei Volkov's simulations of neutron star collisions have produced results that closely _____ the gravitational wave data recorded by the LIGO observatory in 2017. This alignment between theoretical predictions and observational evidence strengthens confidence in current models of stellar mergers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: corroborate

B: supplant

C: precede

D: contradict

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Simulations match observations = confirm each other. 'Supplant' means replace, not confirm. 'Precede' is about timing, not agreement. 'Contradict' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Alignment between predictions and evidence' = mutual confirmation = corroborate.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 55

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Historian Simone Leclerc notes that many medieval European castles were designed not solely for military defense but also to project the political authority of their owners. Elaborate gatehouses, towering keeps, and decorative stonework served to _____ the power of the lord who commissioned them, communicating wealth and dominance to visitors and rivals alike.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: conceal

B: consolidate

C: advertise

D: question

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Features 'communicate wealth and dominance' = publicly display power.

'Consolidate' is the strongest distractor -- it means strengthen/gather power, which lords do, but the passage is about DISPLAYING power to others, not accumulating it. 'Conceal' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Communicating to visitors and rivals' = making power visible = advertising.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 56

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Geneticist Priya Ramaswamy has shown that the genetic diversity of domesticated rice varieties has declined sharply over the past century as farmers have increasingly favored a small number of high-yield strains. This narrowing of the gene pool, Ramaswamy warns, makes rice crops more _____ to disease outbreaks, since genetically uniform populations offer pathogens fewer barriers to rapid spread.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: resistant
- B: vulnerable
- C: tolerant
- D: sensitive

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Less genetic diversity = fewer barriers to disease = more susceptible.

'Resistant' is the reversal. 'Sensitive' is the strongest distractor -- it's close to vulnerable, but 'sensitive to disease' usually describes detection, not susceptibility to harm. 'Tolerant' is a science term meaning able to withstand, which is the opposite.

TRICK: 'Fewer barriers to rapid spread' = more exposed to harm = vulnerable.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 57

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Cosmologist Ingrid Halvorsen proposes that the apparent homogeneity of the cosmic microwave background radiation -- the faint thermal echo of the Big Bang -- is not, as widely assumed, evidence of a smooth early universe but rather an artifact of observational limitations. Halvorsen argues that finer-resolution instruments would reveal subtle anisotropies that current detectors cannot resolve, rendering the prevailing interpretation _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: provisional
- B: indispensable
- C: unambiguous
- D: untenable

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Better instruments would disprove the current view. 'Provisional' is the strongest distractor -- it means temporary/subject to revision, which sounds close, but Halvorsen argues the interpretation would become IMPOSSIBLE to maintain, not just in need of revision. 'Indispensable' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Rendering' + new evidence that disproves = making it impossible to defend = untenable.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 58

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Sociologist Marcus Abernathy contends that the modern nostalgia industry -- a commercial sector built on romanticized versions of the past -- does not simply reflect preexisting consumer sentiment but actively _____ it, creating demand for idealized pasts that never existed through targeted marketing and curated imagery.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: manufactures

B: amplifies

C: documents

D: inherits

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'Does not simply reflect but actively ____' = creates, not mirrors.

'Amplifies' is the strongest distractor -- it means increases existing sentiment, but the passage says the industry creates demand for 'pasts that never existed,' which means it PRODUCES the sentiment from scratch, not merely makes it louder. TRICK: 'Pasts that never existed' = the sentiment is fabricated, not just amplified.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 59

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Sylvia Mwangi's 1966 novel *Dry Season*. The narrator observes a town council meeting.

Councillor Odhiambo listened to the arguments marshalled against his proposal with an expression of studied neutrality. He did not rebut them. He did not flinch. He simply waited, letting the torrent of objections spend itself, and when the chamber had grown quiet, he rose and delivered his reply with a composure so absolute it bordered on contempt.

As used in the text, what does the word "studied" most nearly mean?

- A: Scholarly
- B: Analytical
- C: Practiced
- D: Genuine

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Studied neutrality' = deliberately cultivated, rehearsed calm. 'Scholarly' is the literal-meaning trap. 'Analytical' is tempting because he's analyzing objections, but 'studied' describes the EXPRESSION, not his thinking. 'Genuine' is the reversal -- studied neutrality is the OPPOSITE of genuine. TRICK: 'Studied' + an expression = deliberately maintained, not natural. If it were genuine, there would be no need to note it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 60

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Archaeological evidence from Gobekli Tepe, a Neolithic site in southeastern Turkey, has complicated the traditional narrative that agriculture _____ the development of complex societies. The site's monumental stone structures, which predate the earliest known farming communities by several centuries, suggest that large-scale cooperative projects may have emerged among hunter-gatherer groups before the adoption of agriculture.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: preceded

B: necessitated

C: accompanied

D: documented

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Traditional view: agriculture was REQUIRED for complex societies. Gobekli Tepe disproves this. 'Preceded' is the strongest distractor -- it's about sequence, but the traditional narrative isn't just that agriculture came first; it's that agriculture was NECESSARY. 'Accompanied' is tempting but too weak (co-occurrence, not causation).

TRICK: The challenge is about NECESSITY, not sequence -- 'necessitated' captures the causal claim being disputed.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 61

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Philosopher Emeka Abubakar argues that the concept of "meritocracy" functions as both a descriptive claim about how societies allocate resources and a normative claim about how they should. He observes that conflating these two dimensions allows proponents of meritocratic systems to treat existing inequalities as inherently _____, since the same word that describes the status quo also implies that the status quo is just.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: warranted
- B: illegitimate
- C: inevitable
- D: negligible

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Conflating 'how things are' with 'how they should be' makes inequalities seem justified. 'Inevitable' is the strongest distractor -- it means unavoidable, which makes inequalities seem acceptable, but for the wrong reason. The passage says the status quo is made to seem JUST, not merely unavoidable. 'Illegitimate' is the reversal. TRICK: 'The status quo is just' = deserved/justified = warranted.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 62

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Marine biologist Fatou Diallo has documented the role of parrotfish in maintaining coral reef health. By grazing on algae that would otherwise smother coral, parrotfish perform a function that is _____ to reef survival, yet overfishing has reduced parrotfish populations in many Caribbean reefs by more than 80 percent since the 1970s.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: incidental
- B: complementary
- C: detrimental
- D: indispensable

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Parrotfish prevent algae from smothering coral = critical function.

'Complementary' is the strongest distractor -- it means supplementary/additive, but the passage describes parrotfish as performing a function without which reefs die, which is stronger than additive. 'Incidental' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Would otherwise smother' = without parrotfish, reefs fail = the function is essential, not just helpful.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 63

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Anastasia Volkov's 1938 novel *The Frost Line*. The narrator reflects on a neighbor's departure.

Grisha was not sentimental about the farm. He spoke of the land with a clinician's detachment, cataloguing its deficiencies -- the thin topsoil, the unpredictable frost, the drainage that defeated every remedy -- as though presenting a diagnosis. Leaving, for him, was not an act of surrender but of triage: he had assessed the situation and determined that his efforts were better invested elsewhere.

As used in the text, what does the word "triage" most nearly mean?

- A: Emergency intervention
- B: Ranked prioritization
- C: Reluctant concession
- D: Calculated abandonment

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Grisha assessed the situation and decided his efforts were better invested elsewhere = systematic prioritization of resources. 'Calculated abandonment' is the strongest distractor -- he IS leaving, but the passage says 'not surrender.' Triage means deciding WHERE to invest, not deciding to quit. 'Emergency intervention' is the literal medical meaning. TRICK: 'Better invested elsewhere' = allocating resources by priority, not giving up.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 64

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Economist Javier Castellanos has argued that the proliferation of subscription-based pricing models in the software industry has created a paradox: while individual monthly fees appear modest, their _____ effect on household budgets can be substantial. Castellanos notes that many consumers fail to recognize the _____ nature of these expenses, treating each subscription as an isolated cost rather than as part of a growing aggregate financial commitment.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: transparent
- B: discretionary
- C: cumulative
- D: volatile

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Individual fees add up to a substantial total = accumulating. The blank appears TWICE and both times describes how costs build up. 'Discretionary' is the strongest distractor -- subscriptions ARE optional expenses, but the passage focuses on how they ADD UP, not on whether they're optional. 'Volatile' means unpredictable, not accumulating. TRICK: 'Growing aggregate' in the last line confirms the answer -- costs that pile up = cumulative.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 65

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Bioethicist Nora Lindqvist contends that the increasing use of artificial intelligence in medical diagnostics raises a troubling ethical question: if an AI system and a human physician disagree on a diagnosis, who bears responsibility for the outcome? Lindqvist argues that current regulatory frameworks are _____ to address this question, having been designed for an era in which all diagnostic decisions were made by licensed practitioners.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: inadequate

B: sufficient

C: premature

D: comprehensive

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Frameworks designed for a different era cannot handle the new question. 'Sufficient' and 'comprehensive' are reversals. 'Premature' is tempting but means too early; the frameworks are too OLD, not too new. TRICK: 'Designed for an era in which' = outdated for the current situation = inadequate.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 66

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Cognitive scientist Henri Beaumont's work on confirmation bias has shown that once individuals form a preliminary hypothesis, they tend to seek out information that _____ their existing beliefs while systematically avoiding or dismissing evidence that would challenge those beliefs. This asymmetry in how people process information, Beaumont argues, is more pronounced in domains where individuals feel emotionally invested.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: refutes

B: destabilizes

C: interrogates

D: vindicates

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Confirmation bias = seeking supportive evidence. The blank must mean 'proves right' or 'confirms.' 'Interrogates' is tempting because it sounds like examining beliefs, but interrogating means questioning, which is what people AVOID doing. 'Refutes' and 'destabilizes' describe what people avoid seeking. TRICK: Confirmation bias = seeking validation. 'Vindicates' means proves right, which is what biased people seek.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 67

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Isadora Campos's 1959 novel *The Terrace Garden*. The narrator describes an elderly painter at work.

She applied color with a patience that belied the urgency of her vision. Each brushstroke was a negotiation between impulse and discipline, between the wild image burning in her mind and the obedient hand that translated it onto canvas. The finished paintings, for all their apparent spontaneity, were anything but careless. They were the product of a ferocious deliberation.

As used in the text, what does the word "ferocious" most nearly mean?

- A: Violent
- B: Intense
- C: Hostile
- D: Reckless

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Ferocious deliberation' = extremely thorough thought. 'Violent' is the literal-meaning trap -- deliberation (careful thought) cannot be physically violent. 'Reckless' is tempting because 'ferocious' can suggest wildness, but the passage explicitly says the work was 'anything but careless.' TRICK: 'Ferocious' + abstract noun (deliberation) = extreme intensity, not physical force.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 68

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Political theorist Yara El-Khoury argues that democratic institutions, though often presented as the inevitable outcome of historical progress, are in fact _____ achievements that require constant maintenance. She draws parallels to physical infrastructure, noting that just as bridges and highways deteriorate without regular upkeep, democratic norms and practices can erode when citizens and leaders take them for granted.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: permanent
- B: spontaneous
- C: precarious
- D: inevitable

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Require constant maintenance' + 'can erode' = fragile, at risk. 'Permanent' and 'inevitable' are reversals -- both describe stability the passage explicitly denies. 'Spontaneous' is tempting because it contrasts with 'inevitable,' but the passage isn't about how institutions arise; it's about how they can FAIL. TRICK: The bridge analogy gives it away -- things that deteriorate without upkeep are precarious.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 69

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Biophysicist Adaora Eze has demonstrated that the membranes of certain extremophile bacteria contain lipid molecules arranged in an unusually rigid lattice structure, a configuration that _____ the destabilizing effects of extreme heat. This finding has implications for the development of heat-resistant materials, since synthetic membranes modeled on these bacterial structures could withstand temperatures that would destroy conventional polymers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: counteracts

B: amplifies

C: mimics

D: tolerates

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The structure allows bacteria to survive extreme heat by opposing heat's effects. 'Tolerates' is the strongest distractor -- it means endures without reaction, but 'counteracts' means actively opposes. The passage says the structure enables survival, implying active opposition. 'Amplifies' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Withstand temperatures that would destroy' = active resistance, not passive endurance = counteracts.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 70

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Gabriel Figueroa's 1942 novel *The Copper Mine*. The narrator describes a moment of decision.

For weeks, Tomas had circled the question like a man walking the rim of a well, peering into the darkness below but never quite willing to lean forward. Now, with the letter in his hand and the cold certainty of its contents pressing against his chest, he felt the ground beneath him narrow to a single point. There was, at last, no room left for evasion.

As used in the text, what does the word "narrow" most nearly mean?

- A: Become physically thin
- B: Sharpen in focus
- C: Taper gradually
- D: Contract to eliminate alternatives

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Tomas was avoiding a decision; now 'ground narrows to a single point' and there's 'no room for evasion' = options disappearing. 'Taper gradually' is tempting because it describes physical narrowing over time, but the passage emphasizes the ELIMINATION of alternatives, not the physical shape. 'Sharpen in focus' is tempting because a single point could suggest clarity. TRICK: 'No room left for evasion' = alternatives have been removed. The narrowing is metaphorical: choices shrinking.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 71

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Art critic Josephine Tan has argued that the recent trend of major museums acquiring digital artworks is less a progressive embrace of new media than a calculated attempt to appear innovative without fundamentally disrupting their institutional structures. Tan characterizes these acquisitions as largely _____, noting that most digital works are displayed in peripheral gallery spaces and rarely integrated into museums' permanent curatorial frameworks.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: transformative

B: cosmetic

C: profitable

D: performative

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Appear innovative without fundamentally disrupting' = surface-level change. 'Performative' is the strongest distractor -- it means done for show, which sounds similar, but 'cosmetic' specifically means SUPERFICIAL change (not deep), while 'performative' means done for appearance (an action taken for its signaling value). The passage focuses on the DEPTH of the change, not the motive. TRICK: 'Without fundamentally disrupting' = the change is shallow = cosmetic.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 72

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Anthropologist Kwame Asante has challenged the prevailing scholarly tendency to treat ancient West African kingdoms as isolated entities, arguing instead that extensive trade networks created deep _____ among geographically distant polities. Shared artistic motifs, linguistic borrowings, and uniform weights and measures found across sites separated by hundreds of kilometers all point to sustained economic and cultural exchange.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: rivalries
- B: hierarchies
- C: interdependencies
- D: redundancies

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shared motifs, borrowings, uniform measures = mutual connection and reliance. 'Hierarchies' is tempting because trade networks can create power structures, but the passage stresses SHARED and UNIFORM elements, not dominance. 'Rivalries' implies competition, but the evidence (shared, uniform) points to cooperation. TRICK: 'Shared' and 'uniform' across kingdoms = mutual reliance, not competition or hierarchy.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 73

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Psycholinguist Sven Eriksson's research suggests that the grammatical structures of a person's native language may subtly influence how that person perceives time. Speakers of Mandarin, which commonly uses vertical spatial metaphors for temporal sequences, tend to conceptualize time along a vertical axis, whereas English speakers, whose temporal metaphors are predominantly horizontal, tend to conceptualize time along a horizontal one. These findings lend qualified support to a _____ version of the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis -- the idea that language shapes cognition -- while stopping short of endorsing the stronger claim that language determines thought entirely.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: discredited
- B: comprehensive
- C: radical
- D: moderate

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Findings support the idea that language SHAPES cognition but stop short of saying it DETERMINES thought. = middle ground. 'Radical' describes the stronger version the passage REJECTS. 'Discredited' is too negative -- the findings DO support the hypothesis, just the weaker version. 'Comprehensive' is tempting but describes scope, not position on a spectrum. TRICK: 'Qualified support' + 'stopping short of the stronger claim' = a restrained, middle-ground version = moderate.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 74

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Beatrice Osei's 1977 novel *The River's Daughter*. The narrator describes her mother's reaction to criticism.

My mother absorbed insults the way riverbanks absorb floodwater -- silently, without apparent damage, and with an unsettling patience that suggested the energy was being stored rather than dissipated. She never raised her voice. She never struck back. But weeks later, at some impeccably chosen moment, she would return the blow with a precision that left the original offender wondering how the ground had shifted beneath them.

As used in the text, what does the word "shifted" most nearly mean?

- A: Changed
- B: Rotated
- C: Trembled
- D: Settled

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'How the ground had shifted' = how the situation/advantage had changed without their realizing. 'Trembled' is tempting because it's about ground movement, but trembling implies instability, while the passage describes a completed change that the offender only notices after the fact. 'Settled' is the reversal (stabilizing). TRICK: 'Shifted' in the metaphor = the strategic situation changed. The offender's advantage vanished.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 75

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Computational linguist Aisha Kapoor has developed an algorithm that detects rhetorical patterns in political speeches across five centuries of parliamentary records. Her analysis reveals that while the specific vocabulary of political discourse has evolved considerably, the underlying persuasive structures -- appeals to tradition, invocations of crisis, and claims of popular mandate -- have remained remarkably _____ across historical periods.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: contentious

B: stable

C: influential

D: opaque

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Vocabulary changed BUT persuasive structures 'remained remarkably ____' = unchanged. 'Influential' is tempting because these structures DO influence politics, but the passage is about persistence over time, not impact. 'Contentious' is about controversy, not consistency. TRICK: 'While X evolved' + 'Y remained remarkably ____' = Y stayed the same = stable.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 76

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Molecular biologist Renzo Marchetti's research on antibiotic resistance has yielded a counterintuitive finding: in some bacterial populations, resistance to a particular antibiotic actually _____ when the antibiotic is removed from the environment. This occurs because the genetic mutations conferring resistance impose a metabolic cost; without the selective pressure of the drug, resistant bacteria are outcompeted by their non-resistant counterparts.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: intensifies

B: stabilizes

C: wanes

D: diversifies

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Counterintuitive' signals the answer is opposite to expectation. You'd expect resistance to stay or grow, so it must decrease. 'Intensifies' is the intuitive-but-wrong answer. 'Stabilizes' is tempting because it describes a neutral state, but the passage describes a decrease. TRICK: 'Counterintuitive' = the answer must be the opposite of what you'd expect. Resistance decreasing = wanes.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 77

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from Elara Vasquez's 1953 novel *The Stone Arch*. The narrator reflects on a family disagreement.

The argument had ended hours ago, but its residue clung to the house like smoke. My sister sat at the kitchen table, turning a cold cup of tea in her hands, her silence more eloquent than anything she had said during the quarrel. There are defeats that announce themselves with fanfare, and there are those that arrive quietly, settling into the bones like winter damp. Hers was the second kind.

As used in the text, what does the word "eloquent" most nearly mean?

A: Persuasive

B: Articulate

C: Fluent

D: Expressive

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Silence more eloquent than anything she had said' = silence communicated more powerfully than words. 'Articulate' and 'fluent' both describe verbal communication, but the sister is SILENT. 'Persuasive' is tempting because eloquence can persuade, but the passage is about how much the silence CONVEYS, not whether it convinces anyone. TRICK: The subject is SILENCE -- any word that requires speech is automatically wrong.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 78

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Historian Nadia Sokolova has argued that the popular characterization of the Byzantine Empire as a static civilization, merely preserving the legacy of Rome, fundamentally _____ the empire's considerable intellectual and artistic innovations. Byzantine scholars made original contributions to mathematics, astronomy, and philosophy, and Byzantine architects developed structural techniques -- such as the pendentive dome -- that had no Roman precedent.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: misrepresents

B: elucidates

C: perpetuates

D: corroborates

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The popular view says Byzantium merely preserved Rome; Sokolova says it innovated. The popular view gets the innovations wrong. 'Perpetuates' is tempting because the characterization could perpetuate a myth, but the OBJECT is 'innovations,' not the myth -- you can't perpetuate innovations by calling them preservation. 'Elucidates' and 'corroborates' are reversals. TRICK: Check the object of the verb -- '___ the innovations' = gives a false picture of them = misrepresents.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 79

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Entomologist Clara Nystrom has found that some parasitoid wasp species manipulate their host caterpillars' behavior in ways that go beyond simple parasitism. After emerging from the host's body, the larvae of one species, *Glyptapanteles liparidis*, cause the caterpillar -- still alive -- to guard the wasp pupae against predators, effectively _____ the host into serving as an unwilling protector of the very organisms that consumed it from within.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A: recruiting
- B: conscripting
- C: commissioning
- D: liberating

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The caterpillar is forced ('unwilling') to serve. 'Recruiting' is the strongest distractor -- it sounds like enlisting, but implies the recruit consents. 'Commissioning' is tempting because it means ordering work done, but it implies a legitimate authority and a willing agent. 'Liberating' is the reversal. TRICK: 'Unwilling protector' = forced service. 'Conscripting' means forcibly drafting into service; 'recruiting' implies voluntary enlistment.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 80

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Vocabulary

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Philosopher of science Emilia Torrance has observed that the replication crisis in psychology -- the discovery that many published experimental findings cannot be reproduced -- has paradoxically _____ the discipline by prompting researchers to adopt more rigorous methodologies, preregister their hypotheses, and share their raw data publicly. What initially appeared as a devastating indictment of the field's credibility has become a catalyst for systemic improvement.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: discredited

B: fragmented

C: strengthened

D: legitimized

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: 'Paradoxically' = the result is the opposite of expected. A crisis should weaken, so it must have strengthened. 'Discredited' is the trap -- it's the expected outcome of a crisis, but 'paradoxically' signals the opposite. 'Legitimized' is tempting because the improvements could give psychology more credibility, but 'strengthened' is more precise because the passage describes improved METHODS, not just improved reputation.

TRICK: 'Paradoxically' = answer must be opposite of expected. Crisis expected to weaken, so it must strengthen.

END QUESTION